



▲ **Rune stones** come in sets of 24, each with a different runic symbol in Old Norse style. The diviner invites the seeker to choose one or more of the stones without looking and then interprets the selection.



▲ **Casting dice** is an ancient method of divination called astragalomancy. The dice were originally knucklebones or other small bones of sheep and goats. The skill lies in interpreting the fall of numbers.



▲ **Spirit boards** (often called Ouija boards) supposedly spell out messages from spirits beyond the grave as the pointer mysteriously moves to different letters. In fact, the pointer is moved subconsciously by the participants.

# Divination tools

The process of reading patterns and signs to indicate the future, divination is one of the oldest and most widespread forms of occult practice. Many methods are still popular today, reinvented and reimagined to meet modern needs, especially those of New Age followers. Different cultures have chosen different signs to interpret, and scholars have identified numerous kinds of *mantia* (powers of prophecy)—from abacomancy (divination by dust) to zygomancy (divination by balancing weights).



▲ **Dowsing rods** indicate hidden water or mineral deposits underground as they twitch in response to subconscious movements of the dowser's hand. Originally, dowsers used twigs, but now most favor two L-shaped rods.



▲ **Tea-leaf reading** (tasseography) dates back to the start of tea-drinking but remains popular today. To make a reading, the diviner interprets the pattern of leaves left at the bottom of the cup.



▲ **Scrying mirrors** have an ancient history and are still used as a psychic tool to invoke spirits in the hope that they will offer insight into the past, future, and even events taking place elsewhere in the present.